

Social Buzz Content Analysis — Business Case Study

Accenture North America — Data Analytics & Visualization Job Simulation (Forage)

Client: Social Buzz | Industry: Social Media & Content Creation | Role: Data Analyst

1. Client Background

Social Buzz is a San Francisco-based social media and content-creation platform founded in 2010 by two former engineers from a major social media company. The platform's core differentiator is anonymity: rather than following individual users, Social Buzz tracks over 100 distinct reaction types on every piece of content, keeping trending content — not personalities — at the center of the feed.

Over the past five years, Social Buzz has scaled to more than 500 million monthly active users, with over 100,000 pieces of content (text, images, video, and GIFs) posted daily. Of its 250 employees, 200 are technical staff dedicated to managing this large, unstructured data environment.

2. Business Challenge

Social Buzz had never worked with an external advisory firm before, but three pressures pushed them to seek outside expertise for a 3-month initial engagement:

- **IPO readiness** — targeting an IPO by the end of next year and needing guidance to get there smoothly.
- **Scaling pressure** — the company has grown faster than its internal resources can support, and wants experienced partners rather than simply hiring more staff.
- **Big data best practices** — leadership wants to learn how larger, more mature organizations manage the challenges of massive, unstructured data at scale.

Engagement Deliverables

- An audit of Social Buzz's big data practice
- Recommendations to support a successful IPO
- An analysis of content categories highlighting the top 5 categories by aggregate popularity

My Focus: The Data Analysis Workstream

As the Data Analyst on the engagement, my responsibility was the analytical workstream: cleaning and modeling the raw datasets, merging them into an analysis-ready structure, uncovering trends in content performance, and communicating findings through a dashboard, presentation deck, and video walkthrough for client and internal stakeholders.

3. Methodology

Social Buzz's raw data was spread across seven separate datasets covering content details, categories, and reaction-level engagement — highly unstructured given the platform's 100+ reaction types. The analysis followed a structured pipeline:

Step	What I Did
Data Cleaning	Standardized inconsistent category labels, removed duplicate and null records, and corrected data types across all 7 datasets so they could be reliably joined.
Data Modeling	Mapped relationships between content, category, and reaction tables to build a coherent data model suitable for aggregation and analysis.
Merging Datasets	Consolidated the 7 tables into a single analysis-ready dataset linking each piece of content to its category, content type, and reaction counts.
Exploratory Analysis	Aggregated scores by category, content type, sentiment, and month to identify patterns in what content performs best and why.
Visualization	Built an interactive dashboard to surface KPIs, category rankings, sentiment split, content-type distribution, and monthly trends at a glance.
Communication	Translated findings into a PowerPoint deck and video presentation tailored for both the Social Buzz client and internal Accenture stakeholders.

4. The Dashboard

The final dashboard consolidates content performance across 16 categories and 4 content types into a single view, giving Social Buzz's stakeholders an at-a-glance read on what content resonates most with their 500M+ user base.

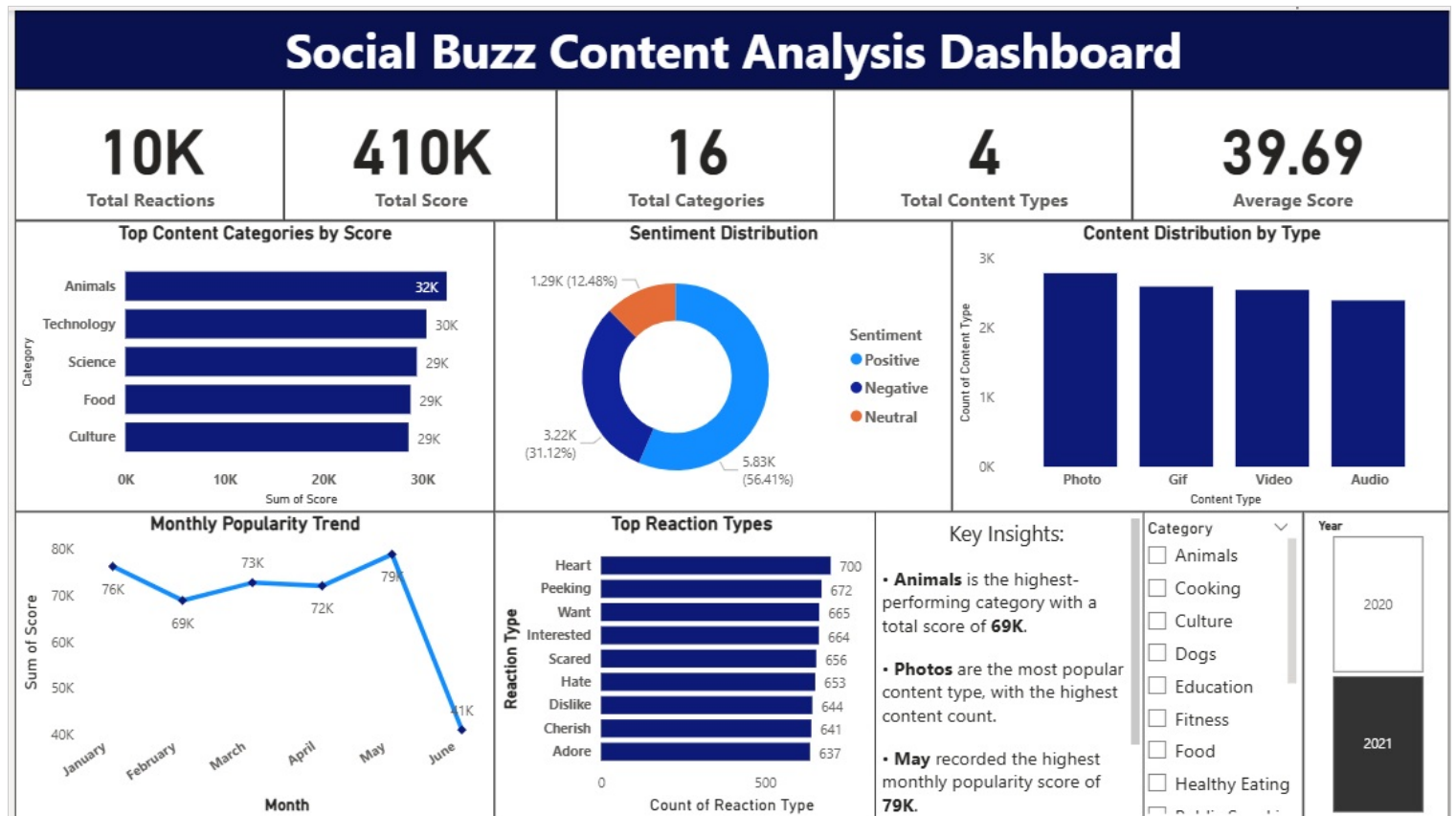


Fig. 1 — Social Buzz Content Analysis Dashboard: KPIs, top categories, sentiment split, content type distribution, monthly trend, and top reaction types.

10K TOTAL REACTIONS	410K TOTAL SCORE	16 CATEGORIES	4 CONTENT TYPES	39.69 AVERAGE SCORE
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5. Key Insights

- Top 5 categories by aggregate score:** Animals (32K), Technology (30K), Science (29K), Food (29K), and Culture (29K) — directly answering the client's core request for a category-level popularity ranking.
- Sentiment is overwhelmingly positive:** 56.4% of reactions were positive versus 31.1% negative and 12.5% neutral, suggesting the platform's content mix is generally well-received by its user base.
- Photos dominate content volume:** Photos are the most-posted content type, ahead of GIFs, video, and audio — an important input for content strategy and infrastructure planning.
- Engagement is seasonal:** Monthly popularity climbed steadily from January through May (peaking at 79K in May) before a sharp drop in June, warranting further investigation into the cause of the decline.
- Reactions are diverse:** No single reaction type dominates — Heart, Peeking, Want, and Interested are all closely clustered in the 630–700 range, reflecting the platform's differentiated 100+ reaction system in action.

6. Recommendations

- Prioritize investment in Animals, Technology, and Science content verticals, which generate the highest aggregate engagement and are strong candidates for creator incentives ahead of the IPO.
- Double down on photo content given its volume dominance, while monitoring whether video/GIF formats are under-indexed relative to user interest.
- Investigate the June drop-off in monthly popularity to rule out seasonality, platform issues, or content supply gaps before it affects growth metrics reported in IPO materials.
- Use the positive sentiment split as a proof point in investor and IPO communications, showing a healthy, well-moderated content ecosystem.
- Formalize the data model built during this engagement as the basis for an ongoing big-data best-practices framework, supporting the broader audit and IPO-readiness workstreams.

7. Skills Applied

Communication, Data Analysis, Data Literacy, Data Modeling, Data Visualization, Presentation Skills, Project Planning, Public Speaking, Storytelling, Strategy, Teamwork.

8. Conclusion

This engagement demonstrates an end-to-end analytics workflow — from messy, unstructured multi-source data to a decision-ready dashboard and stakeholder-facing narrative — mirroring the kind of work Social Buzz would need on an ongoing basis as it scales toward IPO. It reflects both the technical rigor (cleaning, modeling, merging 7 datasets) and the business communication skills (presentation, storytelling) required of a data analyst working with executive stakeholders.

